

of you adults reading this would've had TV as a part of your life growing up. Your formative years weren't ruined and you didn't turn out so bad, did you?

Perhaps there only needs to be a bit of acclimatisation on our part. Perhaps it's just a simple case of dealing with change, establishing boundaries and making the technology work for us the way we want it to. Either ways the question of whether tech is good for kids, is not an easy one to answer. Both sides have to be looked at and in this chapter we shall be doing just that.

Let's play the devil's advocate and start with the bad...

The problem with 21st century tech

Tech overuse, in particular smartphone and tablet overuse, among toddlers according to many researchers may stunt social-emotional and language development and problem-solving skills.

For quite some time now kids-specific tablets such as Mosti's Chhota Bheem Tab or Inte's Eddy Tablet have been available for children, and this huge market exists for a reason. A recent survey by PBS reports that 70 percent of parents polled allow their toddlers and young kids to use their iPad. Now couple that statistic with this one: eighty percent of a child's mental growth happens in its first two years. Scary, huh? Should you be trusting a tablet during such a crucial stage of a child's development?

Ok, so your 2.5-year-old has learnt the alphabet by himself, can phonetically sound them, put them in order and even count to 30, but can he use the letters in any type of linguistic context? Does he understand what these numbers and alphabets actually mean? Your pride may be based on the fact that you could do none of these things at his age, but all he's doing is rote learning, that is, memorising by repetition. Then again, isn't that how all kids learn in the beginning? Evidence suggests that well thought out apps, games and television shows such as Sesame Street can actually help vocabulary and reading comprehension, but only once children are much closer to school age. While the level of engagement is extremely high, thanks to the tech being inclusive and making them feel like their voice is being listened to, these gadgets can't replace the benefits of human attention. Sorry Siri and Dora the Explorer.

Multi-tasking moghuls

It's not uncommon to find children playing a game on their tablet while watching a programme on TV. Or older kids surfing the internet while texting and listening to music. While we applaud their ability to multi-task